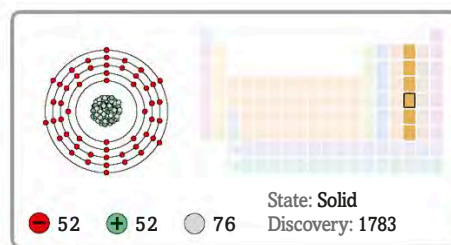


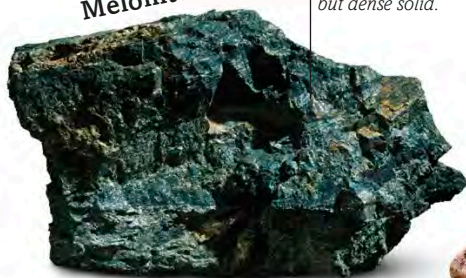
52  
Te

# Tellurium



## Forms

Melonite



*This ore is a soft but dense solid.*

*This metallic crust contains tellurium, gold, and silver.*

Sylvanite



*This semi-metal can form silvery white crystals.*

Pure tellurium crystals refined in a laboratory



## Uses

*These glass fibres contain tellurium.*



*This deep red colour comes from adding tellurium.*

Red-tinted glass bottle



Tellurium **protects** bronze **from corroding** easily in air.

Topaz solar farm, California, USA

*The solar panels are linked to power cells containing tellurium.*



**Tellurium is one of the 10 rarest elements on this planet.** It gets its name from the Latin word *tellus*, which means Earth. This element is often found as a compound with another element, such as the metal nickel, as in the case of the ore **melonite**. Tellurium is also produced as a waste

product when lead and copper are refined. **Pure tellurium** can take on two forms: a shiny, metallic solid or a brown powder. This element is mainly used in the glass of **fibre optics**, which carry high volumes of information much faster than copper cables.